



GEETIKA MEHTA

MANAGING DIRECTOR,
NIVEA INDIA

Skin and personal care is a tough business even in the best of times. Dealing with discerning consumers and the pressure to get it right every time are only some of the challenges. For Geetika Mehta, leading Nivea India is, among other things, a chance to lead a team of 400 and building a digital-ready organisation. At HUL, where she spent 18 years, the experience of working in multiple businesses—personal products, foods, home and hygiene—has stood her in good stead. Post HUL, she spent over two years at Hershey's India as MD before checking into Nivea early 2024.



GUNJAN SONI

COUNTRY MD, YOUTUBE INDIA

Gunjan Soni has an enviable CV. She started off with Infosys as a software engineer before her MBA. Since then, she has worked with McKinsey, Star India, Myntra, Zalora before joining YouTube this April. YouTube's sheer scale in India perhaps swung it for Soni. Over 100 million channels have uploaded content in the last year, with 15,000 of them boasting of over one million subscribers each. YouTube plans to invest Rs 850 crore over the next two years only to accelerate the growth of Indian creators, artists and media companies.



GITA GOPINATH

GREGORY AND ANIA COFFEY
PROFESSOR OF ECONOMICS,
HARVARD UNIVERSITY

Renowned economist Gita Gopinath returned to the world of academia this year as the inaugural Gregory and Ania Coffey Professor of Economics at Harvard University where her research focuses on International Finance and Macroeconomics. The India born economist has had a long innings at the International Monetary Fund where she was the first woman appointed as its Chief Economist, a role she held from January 2019 to January 2022. She then went on to become the First Deputy MD of the Fund from January 2022 to August 2025.

